When I Became a Man

Before Christ, even the heir lived no differently than a slave. In the fullness of time God sent His Son to redeem those under law and make them sons and heirs — so turning back to rule-keeping only trades one slavery for another.

Where this study fits

Galatians · sixteen studies · this study highlighted

01 1:1–5 The Ground of Liberty	**02** 1:6–10 The One True Gospel	**03** 1:11–17 Paul's Independent Revelation	**04** 1:18–2:10 Paul's Gospel Is Independent of the Judean Churches
05 2:11–21 Peter Goes Back to School	**06** 3:1–5 Under a Spell	**07** 3:6–14 Blessing or a Curse	**08** 3:15–29 The Superiority of the Promise to the Law
09 4:1–11 When I Became a Man	**10** 4:12–20 A Steel Fist in a Velvet Glove	**11** 4:21–31 Paul's Old Testament Story	**12** 5:1–12 Taking a Stand in Liberty
13 5:13–26 Walk in the Spirit	**14** 6:1–5 Brothers and Burdens	**15** 6:6–10 Sowing and Reaping	**16** 6:11–18 Teaching the Truth

The child-heir under guardians

Galatians 4:1–3 · Outline I — Our situation

v.1	The heir, while a child, “does not differ at all from a slave”	**νήπιος · δοῦλος** a minor · a slave
v.1	“though he is master of all” — legally owns the estate	**κληρονόμος** heir
v.2	“under guardians and stewards” — over his person and his estate	**ἐπιτρόπους · οἰκονόμους** guardian · household manager
v.2	“until the time appointed by the father” — the date set in the will	**προθεσμίας** appointed time
v.3	“Even so we … were in bondage under the elements of the world”	**στοιχεῖα** rudiments — Jew and Gentile alike

“When the fullness of the time had come”

Galatians 4:4 · Outline II.A.1 — It was the right season

a A common language

Greek, spread by Alexander — precise enough for theology

b Roads and travel

Roman roads let evangelists move town to town

c Pax Romana

Roman peace; citizens protected across the empire

d Bankrupt paganism

Pagan religions offered nothing of eternal value

e The failure of Israel

Failed leadership and a failed mission to the nations

✓ The right Savior

γενόμενον ἐκ γυναικός
born of a woman, born under the law

Four A's of our salvation

Galatians 4:4–7 · Outline II — Our salvation

Arrival	Adoption	Advent of the Spirit	Abolition of slavery
ἐξαγοράσῃ God sent His Son to redeem those under the law	**υἱοθεσίαν** Placed as sons — about the inheritance, not entry	**κρᾶζον** “Abba, Father!” — an ongoing cry	**οὐκέτι δοῦλος** No longer a slave but a son — and an heir
vv.4–5a	*v.5b*	*v.6*	*v.7*

We are born into the family; adoption is about the inheritance — received the moment we believed.

Back to the beggarly elements?

Galatians 4:8–11 · Outline III — Our selection

Ignorant	Illumined	Immersed in the law	About to be dis-inherited
Served those which by nature are not gods	Came to know God — rather, were known by God	Days, months, seasons, years — weak and beggarly	“Lest I have labored for you in vain”
v.8	*v.9a*	*vv.9b–10*	*v.11*

What Paul fears — and what he does not

- Not lost salvation: eternal life, received by grace through faith, is forever
- But trading pagan slavery for law slavery — no better off than before

Discuss and apply

Galatians 4:1–11 · from the study's posted questions and applications

Discuss

1. What is the difference between how we enter God's family (birth) and how we receive the inheritance (adoption)?

2. In verses 9–11, why is Paul “afraid” for the Galatians, if he is not questioning their salvation?

Apply

Let “Abba” Change How You Pray
Begin at least one prayer time this week simply saying, “Abba, Father.”

Don't Trade Grace for Another Slavery
Name one rule-keeping substitute for grace in your life and bring it to a trusted friend or your group.

In one line: You are no longer a slave but a son and an heir — don't go back to the beggarly elements.